

Q. How important is the cloud for Oracle's business?

The cloud is not a new thing; it has been around for years. However, it's only now that enterprises are looking to take advantage of all that the cloud has to offer so they can gain value faster, become more agile and be able to create applications or differentiate themselves from each other. Nobody understands the enterprise software landscape like we do, and we're fully geared to become the most preferred enterprise cloud provider. The beauty of the cloud is that it's a great equaliser, in that the same modern, enterprise-grade cloud can be used by mid-sized businesses as well as startups on a pay-as-you-go model. We already have several cloud customers of all sizes, across industries, benefitting from our modern cloud offerings.

While the cloud is our Number 1 priority, we understand that different customers are at different stages in their cloud journey. We offer them the flexibility and choice of their cloud deployment based on their organisational readiness (public/hybrid/Oracle Cloud at Customer, on-premises).

Q. I am not entirely sure, as of now, whether developers will name Oracle as the key cloud player. Are you following a strategy that approaches customers directly rather than taking the developer route? Or is it because Oracle entered this arena a little late? What's your take on this?

Oracle is the only full-stack, enterprise-grade cloud provider (offering SaaS, PaaS and IaaS) and our customers are increasingly turning to us to future-proof their business. We are building machine learning (ML) and intelligence into each one of our cloud services. If you look at the Gartner report, you will see that we are among the top four providers in the cloud space. Our installed base of customers is extremely interested in understanding what Oracle is offering. They also look into how they can leverage Oracle, not just for the database but also for app integration,

data integration, security, analytics, management and more, using the cloud.

On the SaaS side, various analyst reports indicate that we're well on our way to becoming the world's No. 1 cloud applications player. We started on the infrastructure and platform delivered as service pieces four to five years ago. We are talking a lot about our capabilities, especially in the context of customers, who have extracted some meaningful value from our cloud. Our autonomous database is a good example.

More and more developers are realising why they should use Oracle Cloud — given our modern, open, easy cloud platform.

“Like I mentioned earlier, we're embedding intelligence into each of our cloud services, and at times customers don't even know or realise this.”

Q. Why should developers prefer Oracle rather than your counterparts? What's unique about Oracle's offerings?

At the end of the day, developers think of building an application that connects into some other applications. They might be trying to modernise an on-premise application or build completely new capabilities. And what we have done is — we have created a differentiated value for them at the database tier. They don't have to think about managing and operating a database.

If anyone wants to build a chatbot, we provide a very easy way to do so, with intelligence built into the chatbot — from integration to the back-end system support.

Developers who are building enterprise grade applications should be looking at what we're doing to make their life simpler. If you look at the blockchain, it is a very popular technology, as is Hyperledger Fabric — something that is open source. What we have done is that we

have built an enterprise grade blockchain cloud service, so the security, scalability, and performance is the same as you get from the enterprise grade Oracle database. This helps developers, as they now only have to think about smart contracts that they want to write with APIs. They don't have to worry about any of the underlying infrastructure. In short, our focus is to provide a bunch of tools to the developers so that they're self-sufficient.

Q. Are blockchain and AI the components that developers choose from your cloud services?

First of all, we are embedding AI into all of our cloud services. The autonomous database and analytics have ML built in. Therefore, the developers get access to AI just by using our cloud services. They can pick and choose themselves, for example, management and monitoring applications on the cloud. They do not need to know thresholds. In addition, we are providing the developers the ability to build models, compare models, expose models as APIs, etc. We are also providing these as services to developers. So we're seeing developers use a wide range of our cloud services.

Q. What are you doing to support the developers?

We are doing a few things to support them. First, three years ago, we created a targeted platform to help developers understand the openness of our platform — how intelligent it was and how to easily use it. As part of that initiative, we created a dedicated developer site: developer.oracle.com, where they could get access to all our resources that they were interested in. Second, the goal of the Oracle Code event series — a free knowledge exchange platform for developers, by developers — is to educate them around cutting-edge technologies. These events have a good mix of Oracle as well as non-Oracle speakers. This is helping developers get a 360 degree view of our technology.

We are also empowering developers to try our cloud as a self-service model. However, there is always a connection for them to ask for help. In addition, we